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Dubai approves 80km Fourth Corridor to cut travel time

PROJECT TO LINK ABU DHABI, SHARJAH WITH 12-LANE ROAD, BRIDGES, TUNNELS

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai has approved the implementation of a new 80km Fourth Corridor that will strengthen road links between the emirates and cut journey times by up to 60 per cent.

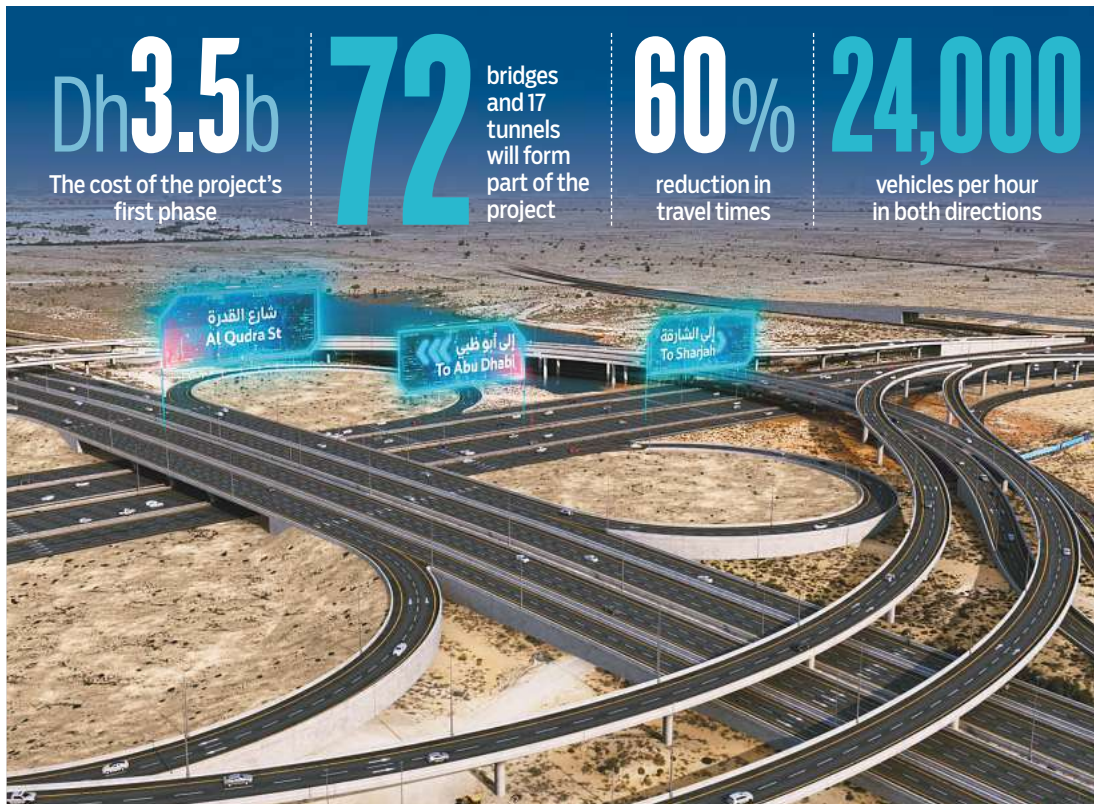
Approved by Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of the Executive Council of Dubai, the new corridor will extend from the Abu Dhabi entrance to the Sharjah entrance, with the first phase costing Dh3.5 billion. It will run from Al Shanoof Street in Sharjah to Dubai-Al Ain Road towards Abu Dhabi.

The project will feature 12 lanes in both directions, 72 bridges and 17 tunnels, and is expected to reduce travel times by up to 60 per cent. It will have the capacity to handle up to 24,000 vehicles per hour in both directions and serve more than 3.1 million residents.

Major connections

The corridor will also include 45 stormwater drainage culverts and connect with Al Maktoum International Airport and Etihad Rail, strengthening links between key transport and logistics networks.

Sheikh Hamdan said the project was being implemented in line with the directives of His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, to



■ More than 3.1 million residents will be served by the new Fourth Corridor which will extend from the Abu Dhabi entrance to the Sharjah entrance.

We continue investing in infrastructure projects, considering them a primary engine for growth, a pillar for elevating quality of life and a support for consolidating Dubai's readiness for the future."

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum

intensify investment in infrastructure. "Through a distinctive project extending 80 kilometres in length, from the Abu Dhabi entrance to the Sharjah entrance, we have approved the

execution of the new Fourth Axis to enhance Dubai's road network and connect it to the emirates of the State," Sheikh Hamdan announced yesterday.

The project is also expected to

support the logistics and commercial transport sectors by providing a major additional route for the movement of people and goods between the emirates.

Sheikh Hamdan said infrastructure investment remained central to Dubai's development plans. "We continue investing in infrastructure projects, considering them a primary engine for growth, a pillar for elevating quality of life, and a support for consolidating Dubai's leadership and readiness for the future," he said.

Saudi Arabia warns Makkah is 'red line'

Outrage across Muslim world after Houthi drone targets Islam's holiest city

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Saudi Arabia yesterday condemned Yemen's Houthis for launching a drone towards Makkah, drawing condemnation across the Muslim world.

Saudi air defences intercepted and destroyed the drone south of Makkah before it entered the city's restricted airspace, according to the Saudi-led coalition. The coalition warned that "the security of the Two Holy Mosques and the pilgrims is a red line" and said it would take "necessary and deterrent measures" against the Houthis. Saudi Arabia's Foreign Ministry reaffirmed the kingdom's right to defend the Two Holy Mosques, pilgrims and Saudi territory.

The Houthis rejected the accusation, denying they had targeted Makkah or other Islamic holy sites.

The incident comes amid renewed fighting between the Houthis and Yemen's internationally recognised, Saudi-backed government. The Houthis have also declared a maritime blockade on Saudi shipping in the Red Sea and expanded their control along Yemen's Red Sea coast near the strategic Bab Al Mandab Strait.

UAE condemns attacks

The UAE strongly condemned Houthi ballistic missile and drone attacks on civilian facilities in Khamis Mushait, Abha and Taif that

The Houthis have declared a maritime blockade on Saudi shipping in the Red Sea and expanded their control along Yemen's Red Sea coast near the strategic Bab Al Mandab Strait.

injured dozens of civilians. The Foreign Ministry called the attacks a flagrant violation of Saudi sovereignty and a threat to its security and stability, reaffirming the UAE's solidarity with the kingdom and support for measures to safeguard its security.

The Organisation of Islamic Cooperation condemned the attacks, saying they violated the sanctity of holy sites and provoked Muslims worldwide.

The Muslim World League described the attempted attack as a "flagrant violation" of Islamic values and basic humanitarian principles.

Arab League Secretary-General Nabil Fahmy condemned the attempt to target Makkah and expressed full solidarity with Saudi Arabia.

Qatar called it a "despicable act of aggression", while Kuwait and Jordan also condemned the attempted attack and backed Saudi measures to protect its security and holy sites. Egypt and Bahrain similarly condemned the incident, with Bahrain calling on the UN Security Council to take a firm stance against Houthi attacks.

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif condemned in the "strongest possible terms" what he called the "dastardly and heinous attempted drone attack" against Makkah.

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Abu Dhabi GP to host F1 sprint race for first time

Season finale for 2027 gets more exciting

DUBAI
BY MANJUSHA RADHAKRISHNAN
Entertainment, Lifestyle and Sport Editor



Formula 1's Abu Dhabi Grand Prix will host a Sprint race for the first time in 2027, organisers Ethara Live have confirmed, following the release of next season's F1 calendar.

The move comes as F1 continues expanding the Sprint format across the calendar, with organisers looking to capitalise on its growing popularity to strengthen the Abu Dhabi Grand Prix's standing as season finale and boost economic returns for the emirate.

Yas Marina Circuit has hosted the finale since the race's inaugural edition in 2009, and remains the only day-night Grand Prix on the calendar.

The 2027 race will run on December 9-12, with the Sprint forming part of an expanded event programme. Contested over 100km with no mandatory pit stops, the Sprint will take

place on the Saturday and carry eight championship points for the winner.

Saif Rashid Al Noaimi, CEO of Ethara, said the deal would "strengthen the event's position on the global calendar and bring more returns for the emirate's economy."

The Sprint format, introduced in 2021, is designed to encourage aggressive, flat-out racing over its shorter 30-minute duration. Yas Marina joins nine other circuits selected to host one in 2027 based on high overtaking potential.

Race weekend will now begin on Friday, with Sprint qualifying and the Sprint itself replacing practice sessions, before Grand Prix qualifying follows as usual on Saturday.

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